WESTON: Roger, it is not alone a question of duty; there is your own success in the world to be considered. It is not your intention to be a secretary all your life, is it? No. Very well. Diligence, and a respect for detail should be your care. I did not become Lord Weston by **twiddling my thumbs** and hoping for favours. I won my honours by hard work and zealous service. Today, I am the best-known, and certainly the most impartial judge in England, and a favoured servant of his gracious majesty, **Charles the Second**. That, I submit, my good Roger, is an example to be studied. It is now only unbecoming in you to ask for a half-holiday, but it is greatly unlike you. I fear….(*He has turned towards his secretary, and discovers his misplaced diligence. After a pause, coldly*) Can it be, Mr. Chetwynd, that you have not been listening to my discourse?

ROGER (*brought to the surface by the cessation of the word music*): What, my lord? Oh, no. Yes, certainly, sir, I am listening.

WESTON: What was I talking of?

ROGER: Yourself, sir. (*amending*) I mean, of your rise to success, my lord. (*It is apparent that it is an oft-heard tale.*)

WESTON: We were talking of your extraordinary request for a half-holiday, when you had one only last month. Would it be straining courtesy too far if I were to inquire what prompts this new demand for heedless leisure?

ROGER: I thought perhaps if you did not need me this afternoon, my lord, I might personally interview the clerk of the Awards Committee, and find out why he has not sent that document.

WESTON: (*a little taken aback*): Oh, Oh, indeed.

ROGER: The lack of it greatly hinders. It holds up my work, you see. And at this most interesting point…. (*His glance goes longingly to his desk.*)

WESTON: That, of course, is a different matter. I see no reason why you should not take a walk to Mr.Clay's in the afternoon if the weather is fine. I am relieved that your thoughts are on sober matters, as befits a rising young man. Diligence, courage, and attention to detail: these are the three. Without an orderly mind no man can hope *(ROGER has gone back to his work*) to excel in any of the learned professions. (*He has found a scrap of paper, rather crushed, in his pocket and smooths its out, uninterestedly, to make a rough spill*). Detail, my good Roger, attention to detail. That is the beginning of greatness. That is the…..(*reading automatically and with some difficulty what is written on the scrap*



of paper) '**Remember Caesar**'. (*Repeating, with vague interest. He turns the paper back and forth, at a loss. And then a new idea occurs to him, a rather horrible idea. To ROGER*) What is the date to-day? (*As ROGER, buried again in his work, does*

12th General_English_Unit_6_C_Supplementary.indd 197 22-02-2020 15:07:40